

Καλλίμαχος ὁ Κυρηναῖος

The Hymns and Epigrams of Callimachus of Cyrene

eul_aid: iso

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή λογοτεχνική [Literary Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Callimachus of Cyrene was a Hellenistic poet and scholar active at the Library of Alexandria during the reigns of Ptolemy II and Ptolemy III. While his exact official position is uncertain, he was a central figure in the intellectual life of the Museum. He engaged in notable literary rivalries, most famously with his former pupil Apollonius of Rhodes, debating the merits of short, polished poetry versus lengthy epic works.

His prolific output, much of which survives only in fragments, includes the elegiac **Aetia**, which explains mythical origins; six literary **Hymns**; the **Iambi**; and the epyllion **Hecale**. He also composed over sixty polished **Epigrams** and produced the monumental prose **Pinakes**, a critical catalog of the Library's holdings that established the foundations of bibliography.

Callimachus's aesthetic preference for learned, refined, and meticulously crafted composition profoundly influenced later Hellenistic and Roman poetry, including the works of Catullus and Ovid. His dual legacy as an innovative poet and a systematizing scholar epitomizes the Alexandrian ideal of learning.

Works (18)

- Αἵτια · [Causes](#) · 213 passages
- Ἐπιγράμματα · [Epigrams](#) · 64 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα καὶ Τίτλος · [Fragments and Title](#) · 52 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Ἐπιγραμμάτων · [Fragments of Epigrams](#) · 3 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Ἀδήλου Συγγραφέως · [Fragments of Uncertain Author](#) · 1 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Ἀδήλου Θέσεως · [Fragments of Uncertain Placement](#) · 1 passages
- Γραμματικὰ Ἀποσπάσματα · [Grammatical Fragments](#) · 5 passages
- Ἑκάλη · [Hecale](#) · 18 passages
- Ὕμνοι · [Hymns](#) · 294 passages
- Ἰαμβοὶ · [Iambs](#) · 63 passages
- Λυρικὰ Ποιήματα · [Lyric Poems](#) · 6 passages
- Ἑλάσσονα Ἐπικά καὶ Ἑλεγειακὰ Ποιήματα · [Minor Epic and Elegiac Poems](#) · 13 passages
- εἰς Ἀπόλλωνα · [To Apollo](#) · 14 passages
- εἰς Ἄρτεμιν · [To Artemis](#) · 12 passages
- εἰς Δῆλον · [To Delos](#) · 14 passages
- εἰς Δήμητρα · [To Demeter](#) · 8 passages

- [εἰς Λουτρά τῆς Παλλάδος · To the Baths of Pallas](#) · 10 passages
- [εἰς Δία · To Zeus](#) · 9 passages